

Company: Barclays

Job Profile: SDE

Offer Type: Placement Only

CTC: 13.5 LPA

Location: Pune

Process Date: 26/07/2025 (OA) and 29/07/2025 (Interviews)

Resume: [Nidhi Resume](#)

The placement process can be hectic and stressful, and it's completely normal to feel overwhelmed. I had tests and interviews before this where I didn't make it, and that's okay, not everything will go your way. Just keep showing up, keep preparing, and trust the process. If it's meant to happen, it will. Stay consistent and don't lose hope.

Placement Process:

1. Online Assessment [135 students appeared for this round]

- The **online assessment was conducted on HackerEarth** and had a **90-minute time limit**.
- It consisted of **12 technical MCQs**, **1 SQL query**, and **1 coding question**.

The **MCQs** were based on **CS fundamentals**, **OOPs**, **SQL**, and **code snippet output prediction**.

The **SQL** question was simple and could be solved using a basic **WHERE** clause with some **AND** conditions. It required interpreting a table to calculate compensation.

The coding question was string-based, required generating a lexicographically smallest string based on mapping rules from two input strings **S1** and **S2** (containing only 'T' and 'F').

You had to construct an answer string such that:

- For index **i**, if **S2[i]** is 'T', the answer substring starting from **i** should match **S1**.
- If **S2[i]** is 'F', then at least one character in that range must differ from **S1**.

The solution required both brute-force thinking and careful handling of edge cases to ensure the final string was valid and lexicographically smallest.

<https://leetcode.com/problems/lexicographically-smallest-generated-string/>
<https://www.thejoboverflow.com/p/p1926/>

Note: The test was exactly the same as the one conducted for the Barclays Summer Internship last year, including the coding and SQL questions. In fact, Barclays has been repeating the same test pattern and questions for the past two years, so going through previous year test experiences can give you a strong edge.

2. Technical Round [37 students shortlisted]

The interviews began around 10:30 AM, but I was called only after the lunch break at 3:00 PM. So, if your slot is later in the day, there's no need to worry, delays are normal.

My interview began with a brief introduction round. The interviewer asked me to introduce myself, followed by questions about my family background, CGPA, and whether I was satisfied with my college and academic performance so far.

Next, he asked me about my primary programming language, to which I responded Java. He then asked a simple DSA question on finding duplicates in an array.

He handed over his laptop and asked me to code the solution in as many ways as I could.

- I first implemented the solution using a HashSet.
- After that, he asked me to make a few variations in the code, which I successfully implemented.

Following that, the discussion moved to Java concepts and Object-Oriented Programming (OOPs).

The interviewer then focused deeply on Exception Handling in Java. He:

- Asked several questions, ranging from basic to advanced level.
- Requested me to code examples using try-catch-finally blocks directly on his laptop.
- Asked about different types of exceptions, their behavior, and expected outputs.
- Also made me predict the output of the code I had written, then verify it by running the program.

While coding and answering, I made a few minor mistakes, but nothing major. The interviewer seemed okay with them, so don't stress too much over small slips.

Lastly, we discussed one of my projects, where I gave an overview and explained the problem statement, tech stack used, and key features.

At the end of the interview, he asked if I had any questions. I asked him about his role at Barclays and the technologies he works with.

That concluded my first technical round.

3. HR Round [21 students shortlisted]

Just 10 minutes after my technical round, I was called in for the HR interview.

The HR round began with the interviewer asking me to introduce myself, followed by questions about the hackathons I had participated in and won.

He then asked me about the company values that were shared during the pre-placement talk (PPT session). He wanted to know:

- What those values meant to me personally
- And how I had implemented any of those values in my daily life

We then had a detailed conversation about the committees I was a part of, and this part of the discussion went on for quite some time.

Towards the end, he asked if I had any questions for him. I took the opportunity to ask about:

- The team he leads at Barclays
- And what kind of work his team is involved in

This brought the HR round to a close.

In total, **16 students**, were selected.

Useful Tips:

- **It's never too late to start.** Whether you're in first year or already into third, what matters is starting **today**. You'll thank yourself later.
- **Choose your primary programming language and stick to it.** Be it Java, Python, or C++, master one language thoroughly. But also have a basic understanding of other popular languages, especially if they come up in interviews or MCQs.
- **Start DSA preparation seriously.** You can follow:
 - The [A2Z DSA Sheet](#) by Striver (great for structured progress).
 - The [CSES Problem Set](#) (excellent for logic building and competitive programming).
- **Keep 1–2 strong, impactful, and preferably unique projects** in your portfolio. Projects that solve real problems, demonstrate initiative, or use newer technologies really help you stand out.
- **Don't ignore your core Computer Science subjects** like DBMS, OS, CN, OOPs, and SQL. These come up a lot in interviews—both technical and MCQ rounds.
- **Participate in extracurriculars!** Being active in **committees**, **hackathons**, and **competitions** not only builds your confidence but also shows that you're a team player and proactive.
- **It's okay to face rejection.** I had tests and interviews where I didn't make it before this offer. But remember: **every failure teaches you something**, and you only need one "yes."
- **Keep your resume updated and tailor it for each company.** Highlight relevant projects, achievements, and internships.
- **Mock interviews help.** Practice with friends or seniors. The more you simulate the pressure, the better you'll perform.
- **Always stay consistent** — even if you can only study or code for an hour a day, it adds up.
- And finally, **never stop believing in yourself.** Confidence and self-belief are game changers.

You've got this! Every small effort counts. The journey might be challenging, but with consistency, smart planning, and the right mindset — **you'll get where you're meant to be.**

Feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#)